

language called IKU. Each pet has a travel journal which record its journeys and can be checked out by the owners.

The business model of this site is similar to Stardolls.com. Shells are the currency here. Shells are divided into three types-Gold, Pink and Green.

Greens are most easily acquired-you just get them by remaining active on GoPets. Pink shells are more valuable and you are awarded Pink shells if you unleash those creative juices and get cracking on making customized IKU icons. Writing messages and testimonials also increase the number of Pink Shells in your kitty. The Gold Shells are the top dog (pun unintended) among 'em all and also the most valuable. You can buy Gold Shells only by real money (US \$, Can \$ and Euros). You can even earn shells when the friends you have invited to join GoPets transact on the site.



The GoPets homepage

Now that you have built up a nest egg what do you do? Simple, spend them. Go to the Shopping area and check out all the cool stuff for your pets. You could buy pet food, mats, drinking bowls, beds, accessories like rings—all sorts of stuff you might want to buy for a real pet. But these folks don't stop at that. You could even buy your pets potato chips and pizzas, teach them to strum the guitar or dress them up and play pirates ~a la~ Pirates of the Caribbean. In fact there is a whole gaming area where members can play games and earn shells. Names of top scorers are featured prominently in the gaming zone. And in case you are hooked to the cute critters you could adopt more pets by spending Gold Shells.

The community features on GoPets are pretty robust .GoLand is the map of the imaginary place where your pets and those of your friends roam about. Find out from the map how far your friends are. Forums for public discussion are available, a feature